

“As a user, I want to split bills so that it is easier.”

A real user story, submitted for a live feature. Here's everything wrong with it.



SWIPE TO SEE WHY →

Three teams walked in with three different features.



No one had framed the problem



Compliance flagged unresolved UPI limits



Engineering wanted scope locked pre-sprint



A junior PM already wrote user stories

There was energy and intent. What was missing was alignment.

The real problem wasn't 'no bill-splitting feature.'

TEDIOUS · UNTRACKABLE · NO REMINDERS

JOB TO BE DONE

"When I split an expense with my group, I want to track who's paid, so I don't have to chase anyone."

Especially for 18–35-year-olds splitting rent, trips, and dining with the same group, again and again.

A good user story sits between 'too vague' and 'too much.'

TOO VAGUE

"As a user, I want to split bills so that it is easier."

- No persona
- No clear outcome
- Not testable



READY FOR DEV

"As a user, I want a bill-split feature in the app so I can divide expenses easily and accurately within a group."

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Given a bill ≤ ₹50,000
When >1 person is included
Then it splits accurately

Alignment before requirements. Requirements before code.

Partial payments, deep UPI sync, and AI-based suggestions all got pushed to later releases — not because they're bad ideas, but because they weren't the problem in front of us.

What's the worst user story you've ever had to rewrite?